

SENDKIT DOCS

Copy that lands (and spintax that sounds human)

Infrastructure gets your email delivered. Copy gets it read and answered. These rules come from watching what actually gets replies across hundreds of real onboarding calls, not from a theory of good writing.

The rules that survive spam filters

- **3 to 4 lines max.** Cold email is not the place for a full pitch. The shorter the email, the more it reads as a real person writing a real message, not a campaign.
- **No links in the first email.** A link in a first-touch cold email is a spam signal before anyone has read your name. Once a reply has landed, a link in a follow-up is far more likely to reach the inbox.
- **No bold, no highlights, plain text.** Formatting is a marketing-email habit. HTML elements get flagged by spam filters faster than plain text, and make an email look like it came from a tool instead of a person.
- **A PS that says reply stop, not an unsubscribe link.** An unsubscribe link reads as a mass-sender signal. A plain PS asking someone to reply stop if they would rather not hear from you does the same job without looking like marketing infrastructure.
- **Short, conversational subject lines.** Something like "quick one" or "following up" reads like a colleague, not a campaign. Save clever subject lines for marketing email.
- **Spintax for variation.** Rotating small pieces of wording across sends keeps every email looking slightly different, which matters both for deliverability and for not sounding like a template.
- **The question-mark follow-up.** A bare "?" as a bump to an unanswered email is one of the highest-reply-rate follow-ups there is. It costs the recipient nothing to answer and does not repeat the pitch.
- **Test with real numbers.** Ten variants split across 500 leads tells you nothing. Run at least 1,000 leads per variant before drawing any conclusion about which copy wins.

Why this matters more than clever writing

None of this is about being a better writer. It is about not tripping the signals, spam filters and human instinct alike, that mark an email as mass-sent. A plain, short, slightly imperfect email from what reads like a real person consistently outperforms a polished one that reads like marketing.

WHY THIS WORKS ON SENDKIT

SendKit's copy fatigue protection watches for early signs a message is getting blocked and automatically rotates the wording before it drags down a whole campaign, so you do not have to catch it manually mid-send.

Rewrite email one against this list

Open a live campaign, pull up its first email, and rewrite anything that breaks a rule above.

[Open your campaign](#)